

Claim Worksheet

CFAN 3091V | Week 6 Wednesday, Evidence Detectives

Name: _____ Date: _____

One sheet per paper. Bring two.

You are not recomputing anything. You are working out what the authors are entitled to say. **“Not reported” and “cannot determine” are answers.** A question the paper does not let you answer is a finding about the paper, not a blank you failed to fill.

The Paper

Short citation: _____

The claim you are inspecting. Copy one sentence from the abstract or discussion, in the authors’ own words.

1. How Many?

Largest number reported (enrolled, approached, planted, sampled): _____

Number actually analyzed: _____

Where it shrank, and what the paper says about why:

Does that final number support a claim about a population, or only about the units actually measured?

2. How Much?

The effect, pattern, or quantity, with its units, separately from any p-value:

Reported uncertainty (interval, standard error, range, or none): _____

Is it large enough to matter in this research context? This is not a statistical question. Say who would notice the difference, and answer it anyway.

3. What Is the Display Not Showing?

Figure or table number: _____

Mark what you can see in it.

☐ Individual observations ☐ Variation or spread ☐ Uncertainty ☐ The denominator

What it conceals, and whether the text makes up for it:

4. How the Analysis Was Chosen

Carried over from Monday. Most papers will not let you answer all of these. Mark what you find.

- ☐ An analysis plan was specified in advance (pre-registration, protocol, or a stated plan) ☐ Cannot determine
☐ The primary outcome named in the methods is the one featured in the abstract ☐ It is not ☐ Cannot determine

Outcomes or comparisons examined: _____

Of those, reported: _____

Does the result stand alone, or does it sit in a pattern the authors show you?

5. Association or Causation

The paper's own wording is: ☐ associational ☐ causal ☐ associational in the methods, causal in the abstract or discussion

Does the design support the version it uses? Name the design feature that decides it.

6. What the Evidence Supports

The strongest conclusion this evidence supports:

One conclusion the evidence does not support, whether or not the paper draws it:

7. Limitation and Question

One design or measurement limitation:

One question you would ask the authors. Specific enough to be answerable.

8. Use in a Proposal

☐ Yes ☐ Yes, narrowed ☐ No

What you would cite it for, in the narrowest wording its evidence carries:
